

CARYOPHYLLALES

The Caryophyllales is a diverse order of 38 families of trees, shrubs, climbers, succulents, and herbaceous plants, ranging from carnations to cacti. Many grow in difficult environments, but have evolved special adaptations for survival. Some have fleshy leaves to store water in drought conditions. Another extreme example is the ability of carnivorous species to trap and digest insects for extra nutrients.



CONOPHYTUM MINUTUM

F: Aizoaceae

A minute, clump-forming species, with fleshy "pebble-like" leaves, this succulent perennial inhabits semi-desert areas in South Africa.



WARTY TIGER JAWS

Faucaria tuberculosa

F: Aizoaceae

Native to semi-desert areas of South Africa, this species has warty leaves that resemble an open mouth, hence the name.



PURPLE DEWPLANT

Disphyma crassifolium

F: Aizoaceae

This procumbent species – with stems that trail along ground – has fleshy leaves and daisy-like flowers. Native to South Africa, Australia, and New Zealand, it lives on saline soils.



many-petalled yellow or light pink flower

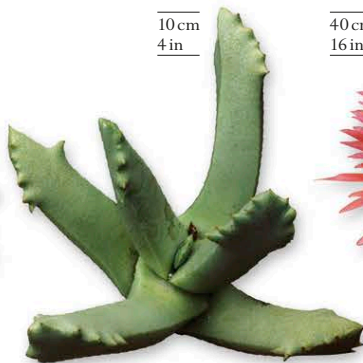
fleshy leaf

HOTTENTOT FIG

Carpobrotus edulis

F: Aizoaceae

This sprawling, fleshy South African species with showy flowers and edible fig-like fruits grows in open dry habitats, where it can be invasive.



SCHWANTESIA RUEDEBUSCHII

F: Aizoaceae

A clump-forming species with unequal pairs of keeled fleshy leaves, this succulent grows on hillsides in Namibia and South Africa.



LAMPRANTHUS AURANTIACUS

F: Aizoaceae

This succulent plant grows in sandflats along the west coast of South Africa, where it is known locally as "vygie".

Its daisy-like flowers are about 5 cm (2 in) across.



TITANOPSIS CALCAREA

F: Aizoaceae

The encrusted leaves of this South African succulent disguise it amongst desert limestone rocks.

It flowers in late summer and autumn.

LIVING STONES

Lithops aucampiae

F: Aizoaceae

Growing among pebbles in semi-desert regions of South Africa, this dwarf clump-forming species has bulbous leaves.



3 cm
1 1/4 in

paired leaves



8 cm
3 1/4 in



30 cm
12 in

ICE PLANT

Mesembryanthemum crystallinum

F: Aizoaceae

Popularly named ice plant for the tiny glistening swellings covering the entire plant, this species inhabits saline areas in parts of Africa, Europe, and W. Asia.



carmine-red flower

10 cm
4 in

bulbous leaf

FAIRY ELEPHANT'S FEET

Frithia pulchra

F: Aizoaceae

This small succulent grows in montane grassland in South Africa. In drought its leaves shrink, pulling the plant into the soil to protect it from desiccation.

GIBBAEUM VELUTINUM

F: Aizoaceae

Pairs of unequal-sized fleshy leaves, joined near their bases, characterize this mat-forming species. It is found in semi-desert areas in South Africa.